

China's 15th Five-Year Plan and international trade

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China's 15th Five-Year Plan (2026–2030), aimed at fostering a "high-quality," "self-reliant" economy, prioritizes "dual circulation" by boosting domestic consumption while upgrading advanced manufacturing (AI, semiconductors, green energy). It focuses on navigating geopolitical tensions by securing supply chains, lowering the 2026 growth target to 4.5%–5%, and expanding high-level opening-up to attract foreign investment.

Key Economic Pillars (2026–2030):

- **Technology & Self-Reliance:** Major investments in AI, quantum computing, biotechnology, and advanced manufacturing to reduce dependence on foreign technology.
- **"Quality-First" Growth:** A shift away from high-speed growth toward sustainable development, boosting domestic demand, and improving livelihood.
- **Green Transformation:** Advancing environmental goals and "Beautiful China" initiatives, making ESG compliance critical.
- **Security Focus:** Ensuring economic and supply chain security in response to rising geopolitical tensions and potential trade frictions.

International Trade & Foreign Investment:

- **High-Level Opening-Up:** Continued focus on easing market access and facilitating foreign investment, particularly in services, high-tech manufacturing, and green industries.
- **Trade Diversification:** Shifting trade routes and expanding cooperation via the Belt and Road Initiative to counter protectionism.
- **Digital & Green Trade:** Actively promoting international digital, green, and service-oriented trade. The plan aims to make China a more resilient, innovation-driven economy while attempting to maintain its attractiveness as a global trade hub despite increasing external headwinds.